

8. ADVANTAGES & DISADVANTAGES

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Team ID	SWTID-2026-4302
Project Name	Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)
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8.1 Advantages

Advantage	Explanation
No code needed	Uses the standard Load Data, Import Set and Transform Map features; Auto Map Matching Fields fills the field maps.
No duplicate records	Coalesce on Employee ID matches existing records, so repeated imports update data instead of inserting duplicates.
Safe staging area	Raw spreadsheet rows land in an import set table first, so the target table is only changed by the transform.
Clear audit of each run	Transform History shows inserted, updated, ignored and skipped counts for every run.
Saves time and effort	Bulk data loads in minutes instead of manual record-by-record entry, reducing typing errors.
Visibility for HR	Reports and the Employee Analytics Dashboards show distribution by department and location.
Reusable pattern	The staging-table + transform-map pattern can be reused for other data and target tables.
Beginner friendly	Covers the full import cycle end to end with simple five-field data.

8.2 Disadvantages

Disadvantage	Explanation
Coalesce needs a unique key	It works well only when the coalesce field is unique; if several target records match, only the first is updated.
Manual uploads	Each file must be uploaded by hand; recurring imports need a scheduled data source.
Header dependency	Column headers must match the target fields for Auto Map to work; otherwise fields must be mapped manually.
Limited audit in target table	Changes made by an import are not tracked in the target table's own audit history.
Validation not automatic	Checks for blank Employee ID, Name or Email need extra configuration (for example an onBefore transform script).
Text-only fields	Department and Location are String fields, so spelling variations can appear in reports instead of using reference fields.

Disadvantage	Explanation
Administrator access needed	Import and dashboard setup requires admin rights (including the ACL Admin Overrides step for dashboard creation).